

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's find out how to communicate without words!



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What gesture do you use to say sorry?
- Do you know of any cultures with gestures different than your own?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about health and wellness.
- I can talk about what has happened or what I've done.
- I can talk about the purpose of an action or an event.



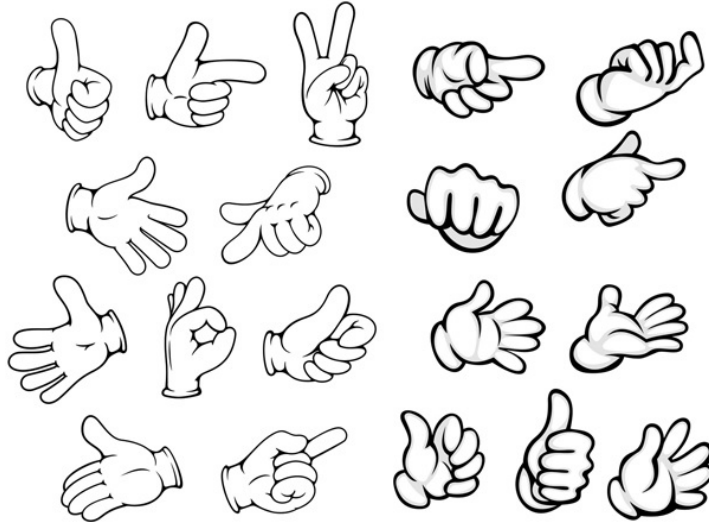


Let's Explore!

Thumbs up* or thumbs down**?

* If you put your "thumbs up", it means you approve of something.

** If you put your "thumbs down", it means you disapprove of something.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Many people have experienced a language barrier in another country, but what they don't realize is that others may not understand their gestures, either.

There are many examples of cultural differences in gestures that could cause misunderstandings. For instance, in America and Britain, in order to show the number "one", a person would hold up his or her index finger. On the other hand, in Switzerland, the thumb is held up. In some cultures, people point at things with a finger, and in others by sticking out their lips or jaw.

Sometimes mix-ups can be very embarrassing. Have you ever given the "okay" symbol, for example? It's when you put your thumb and index finger together such that a circle is formed. Some cultures do this so as to indicate that everything's fine and dandy. You may want to avoid doing this overseas, however, as it is quite rude in many countries.

Those who have had to seek medical attention in a foreign country will know that clear communication is particularly important at the hospital. Let's say you've hurt your knee. The attending physician might press the affected area so that he or she can gauge your reaction. A "thumbs-up" might send the wrong message, and an "okay" sign might be seen as an insult. Of course, if you wince or cry out in pain, the doctor should get the picture.

Further complicating the issue is the fact that if you say or do the wrong thing, there might be nothing you can do in order to express your regret. That's because very few cultures have developed a gesture for "I'm sorry." You could try raising a hand to apologize, but in many places, including North America, you might just end up saying hello!





Let's Practice!

How do customs differ from one culture to another?

Instructions: Circle all the expressions of purpose in the sentence. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. For instance, in America and Britain, in order to show the number "one", a person would hold up his or her index finger.
2. It's when you put your thumb and index finger together such that a circle is formed.
3. Some cultures do this so as to indicate that everything's fine and dandy.
4. The attending physician might press the affected area so that he or she can gauge your reaction.
5. There might be nothing you can do in order to express your regret.



Let's Practice!

What do people do from around the world when they talk about health?

Instructions: Complete the sentences by choosing from the options that you are given. Read the complete sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

attending physician

seek medical attention

wince

lips or jaw

affected area

get the picture

gauge

cry out

fine and dandy

1. In some cultures, people point at things with a finger, and in others by sticking out their _____.
2. Some cultures do this so as to indicate that everything's _____.
3. Those who have had to _____ in a foreign country will know that clear communication is particularly important at the hospital.
4. The _____ might press the _____ so that he or she can
5. _____ your reaction.
6. Of course, if you _____ or _____ in pain, the doctor should _____.





Extension Activity

Make a dictionary of international gestures.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and research gestures used in different cultures.
- On a blank piece of paper, try to draw a representation of each gesture.
- Beside each picture, write a short description of each gesture.
- Show your picture dictionary to a partner, and explain each gesture.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I research nonverbal communication.

☐ ☐

I write definitions.

☐ ☐

I display information in a picture dictionary.

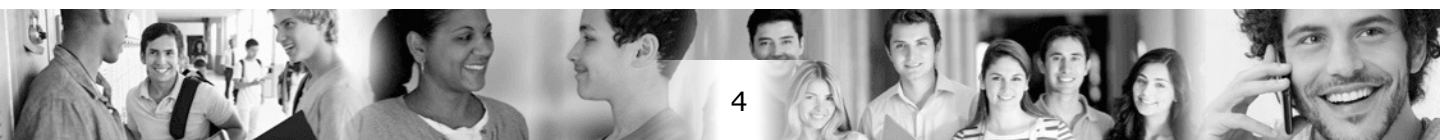
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I explain gestures to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- lip** (noun): the area of skin that surrounds the opening of the mouth
e.g. She gave him a kiss right on the lips.
- jaw** (noun): the two bones around your mouth that hold your teeth in place
e.g. In some cultures, people point at things with a finger, and in others by sticking out their lips or jaw.
- mix-up** (noun): a misunderstanding
e.g. Sometimes mix-ups can be very embarrassing.
- seek medical attention** (expression): to get help from a doctor or other medical professional
e.g. Those who have had to seek medical attention in a foreign country will know that clear communication is particularly important at the hospital.
- affected area** (noun): the part of the body that has been injured
e.g. The attending physician might press the affected area so that he or she can gauge your reaction.
- to gauge** (verb): to measure; to calculate an amount
e.g. Doctors need to gauge patient reactions.
- to wince** (verb): to tighten your muscles in pain
e.g. Of course, if you wince or cry out in pain, the doctor should get the picture.
- to cry out** (verb): to scream or shout
e.g. The child cried out in pain after falling from her bed.
- fine and dandy** (expression): in good condition; okay
e.g. Some cultures do this so as to indicate that everything's fine and dandy.
- to get the picture** (expression): to understand
e.g. He misunderstood at first, but after further explanation he got the picture.





Learning Points

Present Perfect Simple

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a past action or an action that began in the past that is connected to the present in some way.

You can use the Present Perfect tense to talk about experience.

When you use the Present Perfect tense, you think about the past and present together. There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

For example:

Many people have experienced a language barrier in another country, but what they don't realize is that others may not understand their gestures, either!

= the past event of experiencing a language barrier has an effect in the present, as seen in the second clause.

You use the Present Perfect Simple to talk about habitual actions or with state verbs, when there is a connection to the present.

Example:

I've lived here for the past ten years.

= I still live here now.

Examples:

- *Many people have experienced a language barrier in another country.*
- *Have you ever given the "okay" symbol, for example?*
- *Those who have had to seek medical attention in a foreign country will know that clear communication is particularly important at the hospital.*
- *That's because very few cultures have developed a gesture for "I'm sorry."*





Learning Points

The Purpose Clause

You use purpose clauses to express the reasons for an action, or the intended motive of a specific situation.

You use words like *to*, *in order to*, *so as to* or *for* + *-ing* to introduce a purpose clause.

Purpose clauses are subordinate to the main clause. The order of the clauses can be interchangeable, as long as the relationship between the two remains clear.

Example:

*I have come up with a new plan **in order to** stay focused.*

***In order to** stay focused, I have come up with a new plan.*

You use *to* with an infinitive as a way to express purpose. We refer to structure as an Infinitive of purpose.

Example:

*I called **to** find out if the order had been shipped.*

You use *in order to* or *so as to* to emphasize an intention or a necessity.

Example:

*I would like to call for a meeting **in order to** / **so as to** address the current issues in the restaurant.*

You use *in order that* or *so that* when the second clause starts with a pronoun or a noun.

Example:

*You need to give me an answer, **so that** / **in order that** I can address the problem quickly.*

You also use *for* + verb *-ing* to express purpose and intended use.

Example:

*These boots are made **for walking**.*

Examples:

- *In America and Britain, in order to show the number "one", a person would hold up his or her index finger.*
- *It's when you put your thumb and index finger together such that a circle is formed.*
- *Some cultures do this so as to indicate that everything's fine and dandy.*
- *The attending physician might press the affected area so that he or she can gauge your reaction.*

